

President's Report AGM Spring 2023

Thank you to all TIRRA members for their continued support and guidance.

There are a vast number of unsung heroes who support the Executive Board in their work. A big thank you to those who help TIRRA Executive in provision of services such as Transportation, Solid Waste, Espokes, Trails and St. Margaret's Cemetery. The volunteer work of the board and its many helping hands is appreciated. I extend my personal thanks to each of the Officers, Committee Chairs, Employees and Volunteers.

General Activities in which President has been involved in 2022:

TRAILS

Thank you to land owners who have participated in licencing across their property to enable a fantastic trail system. Thank you to those who do the maintenance work and for all the collaboration that happens behind the scenes to make accessing nature on our beautiful island so amazing.

Portal Holdings and Island's Trust Conservancy have not yet resolved the licencing for Fairy Slipper. Extension of TIRRA's involvement for licencing will continue to facilitate use of this specific trail. Without TIRRA involvement, the trail would not be open for recreational use. Current agreement between Portal and TIRRA will be renewed in April 2023 for at least one more year. It is on annual review, so as not to lose sight of the expectation to replace the current licence with one between Portal Holdings and Island's Trust Conservancy.

WELCOME

As there is currently no Committee Lead for the Welcome Committee, I have been coordinating. Thank you to Bev Greene and Greg Gall for meeting with our new residents and to Susan Unger (and sometimes Karl) for preparing welcome packages!

SOLID WASTE

A recap of the year would be incomplete without acknowledging the tireless work undertaken by the Executive in the late summer and fall. Thank you to each board member for their tenacity as there were trying times working through bylaws and notifications and revotes. The work was necessitated due to bylaws not being compliant to the Societies Act.

We were required to conduct another vote, regarding the 2023 Solid Waste Operation Budget, after changing the bylaws to properly adhere to notification requirements. The vote on November 19th resulted in the community decision to operate the Solid Waste Yard as a garbage only facility.

I wish to personally thank Louise Esquirol as she has continued to work, rain or shine, and mostly by herself, since March 2020. Thank you, Louise for always being there with a smile, especially through this summer when emotions were high over solid waste service.

Other Updates:

- We are still waiting to hear from the Federal Government about the grant application the CVRD made in 2021 for Connectivity/Internet funding.

- o TIRRA received a request from Innovation, Science and Economic Development Canada 21 under the Access to Information Act (AIA). The document requested is an email sent on behalf of the Community, to the CVRD asking them to work with suppliers to address our connectivity needs. We complied with the AIA request.

There has been a lot of community conversation about inclusiveness of decision making, information sharing and fiscal accountability. TIRRA Executive are working on three documents to guide us in delivering services to the community: a Code of Conduct, Vision Statement and Mission Statement. The board has agreed we have the common goal of serving our community as volunteers; supporting Thetis Island in matters important to all residents and ratepayers.

There have been three divisive issues over the last 3 years: first the Covid vaccine issue, then the Connectivity/Cell Tower issue, and then the Recycle. I hope the future brings reconciliation so the entire community can be as one: celebrating diversity of opinion, and coming together in democratic solutions.

Thank you for your ongoing support of the hardworking volunteers who coordinate advocacy and services on your behalf. If you are interested in joining TIRRA as a paid member, a board member, or a volunteer, please reach out to tirra@thetisland.net

I have been President of TIRRA for 5 years, and feel it is time for a change. I will be stepping down at the AGM in Spring 2023, and I am willing to move to the position of Past President, if deemed appropriate. Thank you to all who have assisted me over my term(s).

Regards, Wendy Hinsperger, TIRRA President